

Game Day Pre-Shift

Every Ohio State home game, and anything else that turns the block into a two-hour wait. Fill this in before doors, then read it out loud. Do not summarize it.

DATE _____ MATCHUP _____ DAY _____ EXPECTED VOLUME _____

SHIFT AM / PM _____ MANAGER ON DUTY _____

Game day is not a busy night

A busy night builds. Game day arrives all at once, twice, with a dead hour in the middle that makes people forget the second wave is coming. Write these times on the board.

WINDOW 01 Pre-game Volume, speed, turn-and-burn. Guests have a hard out. If you are slow, they leave and eat somewhere else. TIME _____	WINDOW 02 Game window The floor thins and the bar fills. Standards slip here because it feels slow. It is not slow. It is the setup. TIME _____	WINDOW 03 Post-game The hardest 90 minutes of your week. Everyone arrives at once and half of them have already been drinking. TIME _____
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National anthem

When the anthem starts, the staff lines up behind the bar and faces the projector screen. All of you. Everything stops. No pouring, no running food, no ringing tickets, no side conversations. Hands empty, hats off, eyes on the screen. It is ninety seconds. In a room full of people who have never been here, it is the ninety seconds they remember. Get the floor ready before it starts, not during it.

ANTHEM TIME _____ WHO CALLS THE FLOOR TO STOP _____

The three hard lines

Say all three out loud, every game day. Zero tolerance. Nothing follows them.

NO DRINKING

You do not drink before your shift. You do not drink on your shift. You do not drink on the clock in any capacity. Not a shift beer. Not a taste. Not a sip to describe it to a table. Not because a guest bought it, not because it was going to get dumped, not because the game went into overtime. If you smell like it when you walk in, you are going home. We are serving alcohol to a full building of people who are drinking hard — the person pouring it has to be the most sober one in the room.

NO PROMO BOTTLES

No bottle leaves the bar as a promo, a comp, a gift, or a bucket for a table. Every bottle gets rung in and gets paid for. Every single one. A promo bottle is not generosity. It is inventory walking out the door with no ticket behind it, and on game day it is the easiest thing in the building to hide. This is not the same thing as bottle service. Bottle service is a product we sell and ring at full price — sell it hard. A promo bottle is one that leaves without a ticket. Sell every bottle. Give away none.

NO DISCOUNTS

Every check rings at full price. No employee rate for a friend. No "take care of them." No comping the round because the kitchen was slow — that is a manager's call and a manager's ring. You do not have discount authority. Not on game day, not ever.

What you do instead

If a guest needs to be taken care of, get a manager. That is the entire process.

You will never get in trouble for getting a manager. You will get in trouble for making the call yourself.

That is not a threat. That is the basis of the relationship. Every one of these lines exists because the only way we can trust the floor with a full building is if nobody is making financial decisions alone.

ID'ing — no exceptions, not on game day

The liquor license is the entire business. Game day is the night we get tested on it.

Every guest who looks under 40 gets carded. Every time. At the bar, at the table, and again if someone hands them a drink they did not order. A busy bar is not a reason to skip it — it is the reason someone tries it.

Physical ID only. Expired is not an ID. A vertical license means look twice and do the math out loud.

If you are not sure, you do not pour. Hand it to a manager. Nobody gets second-guessed for using that door, and nobody gets a pass for skipping it.

One bad pour costs more than the whole night made.

CARDING AT DOOR CARDING AT BAR

The board

GAME TIME DOORS

GOAL / CONTEST FOR THE DAY

NEW BEERS / NEW ITEMS

86

PARTIES / EVENTS

OTHER IMPORTANT NOTES

Promos for the day

Everybody knows all three before doors. If a guest has to ask what the special is, we missed it.

Suncruiser buckets

Lead with this at every table in the pre-game window. It is the fastest ticket in the building.

6 / 30

Lucky One Lemonade

Same play. Buckets land on the table before the first food order goes in.

6 / 24

Tito's bottle service

This is the one we are chasing tonight. Offer it to every large party, every booth, every group that walks in already celebrating. It rings at full price like everything else — bottle service is sold, never comped.

PUSH HARD

OTHER PROMOS / ANYTHING ADDED TODAY

Staff counts & completions

Run it twice. Game day turns over mid-shift, and the PM crew walks into a different building than the AM crew opened.

AM CREW

STAFF #'S		
	ON	TRAINING
SERVERS		
BARTENDERS		
CAFÉ		
HOSTS		
RUNNERS		
BARBACKS		
SHOT GIRL		
MANAGERS		
SCHEDULED 0 0		
ON SHIFT 0		

SHIFT LEADS	
SERVER	
CAFÉ	
BARTENDER	
HOST	
BAR	
BARBACK	

STAFF TO COACH · 1 HUDDL	
SERVER	
BAR	
CAFÉ	
HOST	
BARBACK	

7SHIFTS COMPLETION	
SERVER	
BAR	
CAFÉ	
HOST	
BARBACK	

PM CREW

STAFF #'S		
	ON	TRAINING
SERVERS		
BARTENDERS		
CAFÉ		
HOSTS		
RUNNERS		
BARBACKS		
SHOT GIRL		
MANAGERS		
SCHEDULED 0 0		
ON SHIFT 0		

SHIFT LEADS	
SERVER	
CAFÉ	
BARTENDER	
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STAFF TO COACH · 1 HUDDL	
SERVER	
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CAFÉ	
HOST	
BARBACK	

7SHIFTS COMPLETION	
SERVER	
BAR	
CAFÉ	
HOST	
BARBACK	

Station assignments

A name on every line before doors, for both crews. An unassigned station is an unowned station.

AM CREW

HOST	
FIRST IN COMMAND	
SECOND IN COMMAND	
RUNNER	
WATERS	
BATHROOMS	

RUNNERS	
BAR 100	
BAR 200	
FOOD	

BAR	
100	
105	
110	
200	
PATIO	

BARISTA	
POS 1	
POS 2	
COCKTAIL 1	
COCKTAIL 2	

BARBACKS

MAIN BAR

PATIO BAR

MAIN FLOOR

CAFÉ

FRONT PATIO

SHOT GIRL

ON TONIGHT

TASTE PLATE

RUNNING IT

SOCIAL MEDIA

ON TONIGHT

BACKUP / 2ND HALF

PM CREW

HOST

FIRST IN COMMAND

SECOND IN COMMAND

RUNNER

WATERS

BATHROOMS

RUNNERS

BAR 100

BAR 200

FOOD

BAR

100

105

110

200

PATIO

BARISTA

POS 1

POS 2

COCKTAIL 1

COCKTAIL 2

BARBACKS

MAIN BAR

PATIO BAR

MAIN FLOOR

CAFÉ

FRONT PATIO

SHOT GIRL

ON TONIGHT

TASTE PLATE

RUNNING IT

SOCIAL MEDIA

ON TONIGHT

BACKUP / 2ND HALF

Game day open — 90 minutes before doors

Work this in order. Do not delegate the first two.

- ☐ **Know the game**
Kickoff, expected attendance, national TV or not, weather. Write the times on the board.
- ☐ **Build the three windows on paper**
Cut times, breaks, and the post-game all-hands are decided now — not at 9pm when you are underwater.
- ☐ **Staffing confirmed against 7shifts**
One no-show on a Tuesday is an inconvenience. One no-show on game day is a two-hour wait.
- ☐ **A name on every station above**
Host, runners, bar, barbacks, shot girl, taste plate. An unassigned station is an unowned station.
- ☐ **Every staff member can name all three promos**
Suncruiser buckets, Lucky One Lemonade, Tito's bottle service. Ask two people at random before you let pre-shift end.
- ☐ **Anthem time on the board**
Every staff member knows to line up behind the bar and face the screen when it starts.
- ☐ **Social media assigned, phone charged, shot list known**
They know what they are capturing tonight before they walk the floor.
- ☐ **Every station walked, front and back**
The 3 Rules on all of them. A station that starts wrong will not fix itself at volume.
- ☐ **Bar par doubled**
Ice, kegs, backups, garnish, glassware, batch. Run out at 7pm and you are done for the night.
- ☐ **86 board walked with the kitchen**
Current and visible. Nothing gets sold that we cannot make.
- ☐ **TVs, sound and the game feed tested**
Every screen, game up, before a single guest sits down.

- ☐ **ID check covered**
Door and bar both know who is carding, and the light works.
- ☐ **Restrooms stocked and clean before doors**
Walk them yourself. It is the first thing a full building destroys.
- ☐ **POS, printers and card processing tested**
Fire a live ticket. A processor going down at post-game is a night-ender.
- ☐ **Door, patio and line plan**
Where the wait forms, who holds it, and how they are talking to it.

Is staff in uniform?	YES / NO	Servers have wine key & lighter?	YES / NO
ID'ing everyone under 40?	YES / NO	Bar par doubled for post-game?	YES / NO

****REMIND STAFF TO TEXT FRIENDS TO COME VISIT****

By position

Read the block that belongs to each group. Everyone hears the bar block.

BAR - ID before you pour. Every time, no exceptions, however deep the rail is stacked. - Every drink rings before it pours. The bar is the highest-volume, lowest-visibility station in the building — that discipline is the whole ballgame. - No promo bottles. No comps. Full price, every ticket. - Cut people early and tell a manager immediately. You will over-serve someone tonight if you are not deliberate about it. - Backups get stocked during the game window, not after it. The lull is prep for the post-game wave.	HOST - Own the door and own the wait. An accurate quote is worth more than a short one — give a real number, then beat it. - Card at the door when the room is young. It is far easier there than at the bar with a drink already poured. - First in command runs the book. Second in command steps in the moment first gets pulled — the door never goes unowned. Runner, waters and bathrooms all have a name on them before doors. - Keep the line moving off the sidewalk and out of the entry. Feed the wait to the bar so they can pick up bodies.	SERVERS - Greet inside 30 seconds. Guests are on a clock and they know it. - Ask the timing question first — "are you trying to be out by kickoff?" — then fire the ticket accordingly. - Card every table before the first round lands. Not after. - Full hands in, full hands out. Every trip. - Primary job is your guests. Secondary is finding work: run food, run drinks, bus tables. Tertiary is helping the person next to you. - No discount authority. A guest issue goes to a manager immediately, not at the end of the rush.
SOCIAL MEDIA - Work the room all night, not just the first hour. The best footage is the post-game room, and that is when most people have already put the phone away. - The shot list: the staff lined up behind the bar during the anthem, buckets landing on tables, the bottle service pour, and the bar at full tilt. - Shoot people who want to be shot. Ask first. Never a minor, never a check, never a POS screen. - Post in the game window, not in the crush. You are on the floor to capture it, not to stand in it.	RUNNERS & BARBACKS - You set the pace of the whole building. Tables turning is the only thing standing between us and a 90-minute wait. - Bar 100 and Bar 200 stay on their own bar — you do not both drift to whichever one is loudest. - Run food. Every one of you. Full hands in, full hands out.	KITCHEN - Prep to game-day pars, not weeknight pars. Confirm with the manager before service, not during it. 86 goes to the manager the moment you see it coming — not when you hit zero. - Ticket times get called every window. Pre-game and post-game are two different fights. - Original position, original condition on every station at every changeover.

Manager floor discipline

- **Be on the floor.** Not in the office. Game day is not a paperwork night.
- **Touch tables before the rush and after it.** During the crush you are expediting, not visiting.
- **Watch the bar specifically.** Volume, comps, voids, ID checks and over-service all live in the same place.
- **Every void and comp goes through you, and you ring it.** If a number moves on a check, your name is on it.
- **Back every refusal.** If a bartender or host turns someone away on an ID, they are right until proven otherwise, in front of the guest.
- **Model the standard.** If you want your staff to smile at tables, you must smile at tables. If you want them to have a sense of urgency, you must always have a sense of urgency.
- **Correct in the moment, quietly, and move on.** Correction on a game day is normal. Public correction is not.
- **Feed your people.** Breaks happen in the game window. Put them on the board and hold to it.

Post-game & close

The night is not over when the building empties.

- ☐ **All hands on the floor before the final whistle**
Not after. If you are still cutting staff when post-game hits, you are already behind.
- ☐ **Full bottle count and bar inventory tonight**
Not tomorrow. Game day is the night the numbers matter most.
- ☐ **Every void, comp and discount reconciled to a manager name**
If one does not have a name on it, find out why before you leave.
- ☐ **Every refusal and cut-off logged**
What happened, who made the call, what time. This is the record that protects the license.
- ☐ **Every station back to original position, original condition**
The 3 Rules do not get suspended because it was busy.
- ☐ **Shift notes written before you leave**
What we ran out of, where the wait broke down, what the next game day needs to be different.

MARKETING



The standard does not move because the building is full.

Game day is the night we get judged by the most people at once. Half that building has never been to TownHall before and will decide what we are in the first ten minutes.

100% of our standards, 100% of the time, at 100% volume. A full house is not an excuse to run at 80% — it is the reason we hold the line.

If at any time you feel like you cannot execute your job and our standard, tell a manager. That door is open all night.